Curriculum Vitae

Stephanie Y. Chia 賈媛

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Education

2026 **Ph.D. Behavior, Ecology, Evolution, and Systematics**, University of Maryland, USA
Advisor: Bill Fagan

2017 **M.S. Sustainable Business and Innovation**, Utrecht University, Netherlands

2015 **B.S. Life Science**, National Taiwan University, Taiwan

Professional Appointments

2026- **Postdoctoral Fellow**, Smithsonian National Museum of Natural History, USA
Advisors: Carla Dove, Helen James, Scott Yanco

2019-2021 **Research Assistant**, Biodiversity Research Center, Academia Sinica, Taiwan
Advisor: Mao-Ning Tuanmu

2017-2019 **Assistant Engineer** (Climate Change Innovative Actions Team), SGS Ltd., Taiwan

Fellowships

2026-2028 Peter Buck Postdoctoral Fellowship, Smithsonian Institution ($144,000)

2024-2026 Taiwan Ministry of Education Study Abroad Scholarship ($32,000)

2024 Smithsonian National Zoo and Conservation Biology Institute Fellowship ($3,750)

2022 National Science Foundation Global STEWARDS Fellowship at the University of Maryland

2021-2022 University of Maryland Dean's Fellowship ($5,000)

Peer-reviewed Publications

Chia SY, Tsai-Chen Y, Cheng Y-R Tuanmu M-N, Fagan WF. (2026). Predation, climate, and life-history traits shape macroecological patterns of enclosed bird nests. *Global Ecology and Biogeography, 35*(6), e70265.

Chia SY, Swain A, Josephs N, Lin L, Fagan WF. (2026). Birds that don't exist: niche pre-emption as a constraint on morphological evolution in the Passeroidea. *Ecology Letters, 29*(2), e70320.

Fagan WF, Krishnan AG, Fleming CH, Sharkey E, Chia SY, Swain A, … 170+ authors. (2025). Wild canids and felids differ in their reliance on travel routes with implications for encounter dynamics. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 122*(40), e2401042122. (cover article)

Chia SY, Wu S, Lu Y-J, Jang Y-S, Huang C-C, Shen S-F, Chen I-C, Tuanmu M-N. (2024). Mechanistic understanding of how temperature and its variability shape body size composition in moth communities. *Functional Ecology, 38*(1), 206-218. (shortlisted for Haldane Prize)

Chia SY, Fang Y-T, Su Y-T, Tsai P-Y, Hsieh C, Tsao S-H, Juang J-Y, Hung C-M, Tuanmu M-N. (2023). A global dataset of bird nest traits. *Scientific Data, 10*, 923.

Tsai P-Y, Ko C-J, Chia SY, Lu Y-J, Tuanmu M-N. (2021). New insights into the patterns and drivers of avian altitudinal migration from a growing crowdsourcing data source. *Ecography, 44*(1), 75-86.

Presentations

Talks

2026 Society for Integrative and Comparative Biology, Portland, OR, USA.

2025 Ecological Society of America, Baltimore, MD, USA.

2024 Mathematical Biology Seminar, Department of Mathematics, University of Maryland.

2023 American Society of Agronomy, Crop Science Society of America and Soil Science Society of America, St. Louis, MO, USA.

2023 American Ornithological Society and Society of Canadian Ornithologists, London, ON, Canada.

2022 Belmont Forum Climate Environment and Health Early Career Researcher Workshop, virtual.

2021 Congress of Animal Behavior and Ecology, Taiwan, virtual.

Posters

2024 American Ornithological Society, Estes Park, CO, USA.

2021 Ecological Society of America, virtual.

2020 British Ecological Society, virtual.

Teaching Experience

Nature at Risk: Extinction, Consequences, and Strategies (HNUH 258C), University of Maryland
Teaching assistant (Fall 2025), Course material development (from Fall 2024 to Summer 2025)

Population Ecology (BSCI 462 / BIOL 708R), University of Maryland
Teaching assistant (Spring 2024), Guest lectures (Spring 2025)

Human Anatomy and Physiology (BSCI 201), University of Maryland
Teaching assistant (Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023)

Awards and Grants

Honors and awards

2024 Best Graduate Research Talk, University of Maryland BISI-BEES Program

2023 Outstanding Graduate Teaching Assistant Award, University of Maryland

Travel grants

2024 Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, University of Maryland

2024 Biological Sciences Graduate Program Travel Award, University of Maryland

2024 Department of Biology Travel Award, University of Maryland

2023 Global STEWARDS Travel Grant

2023 Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, University of Maryland

2023 International Conference Student Support Award, University of Maryland

2023 American Ornithological Society Travel Award

Service and Outreach

2026	Invited reviewer: *Scientific Reports*, *Journal of Avian Biology*
2022-2025	Served on three graduate student organization committees, University of Maryland
2022, 2025	Science outreach interviews, Montgomery Blair High School, MD
2022	Seminar committee, Global STEWARDS Program
2019, 2020	Developed educational materials and conducted public outreach activities, Academia Sinica
2018	Co-authored a winning proposal for social housing resource integration platform, Taiwan
2017	Co-initiated a polylactic acid (PLA) cups recycling initiative, Netherlands (link)
2015	Contributed to drafting and lobbying of a nuclear waste management bill (pushed through first reading), Taiwan

Skills

Programming languages and software
R, Python, HTML & CSS, Git, QGIS, Gurobi

Ecological and computational skills
High-performance computing, Topological data analysis, Linear programming, Phylogenetic comparative methods, Ancestral state reconstruction, Spatial statistics, Network analysis, Species distribution modeling

Languages Mandarin Chinese, English

Others WMA wilderness first responder, PADI advanced open water diver, NCMW adult mental health first aid certification